

MONOLITHS TO MODERNISM

Europe

Pagan worship of natural forces inspired the first structures across Europe. These were made using ingenious techniques and knowledge of astronomy. Later, in Greece and Rome, worship of gods in human form led to new architectural wonders governed by Classical principles. A rational, mathematical approach also enabled later European architects to innovate, especially in the Romanesque and Gothic periods and later in the modern era. In the 6th century CE, Byzantines introduced Eastern elements to architecture and shifted from stone to brick—later used to great effect in the Renaissance. Materials drove creativity in later centuries: from the Baroque mastery of stucco to the Modernist and Contemporary obsession with concrete and glass.

THE ANCIENT GREEKS

800–146 BCE

Adhering to a set of strict aesthetic values, ancient Greek builders set precedents that would be revived numerous times over the following millennia. They developed the principles of symmetry and scale and established the column, capital, and pediment as enduring architectural devices.

5 PARTHENON



THE ROMANS

509 BCE–476 CE

Although inspired by the ancient Greeks, the Romans created their own architectural models, which spread throughout their empire, influencing European cities long after their retreat. Most notable was their use of the arch and the dome as basic architectural devices.



9 THE PANTHEON

NEOLITHIC MONUMENT BUILDERS

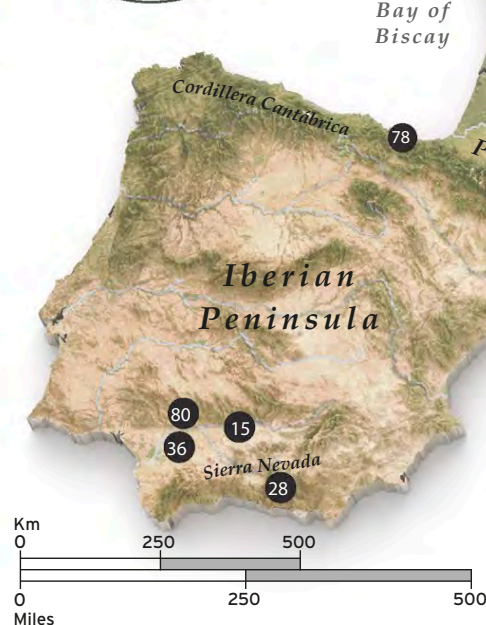
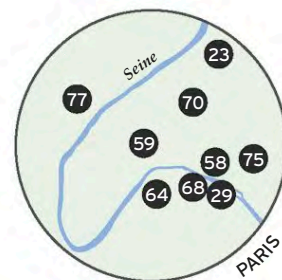
4000–1700 BCE

Powerful pagan beliefs underpinned many of the Neolithic buildings across Europe. Often using limited tools and without wheeled transportation, early builders shifted enormous boulders, cleaved quartzite and granite, and excavated huge volumes of earth to make tombs and religious monuments.



1 NEWGRANGE

more than 5,000 years old, Newgrange combined a long tradition of tomb building with a new idea of aligning monuments with astronomical landmarks



Mediterranean